

🌟 Visual crash course

SaaS & Selling Online

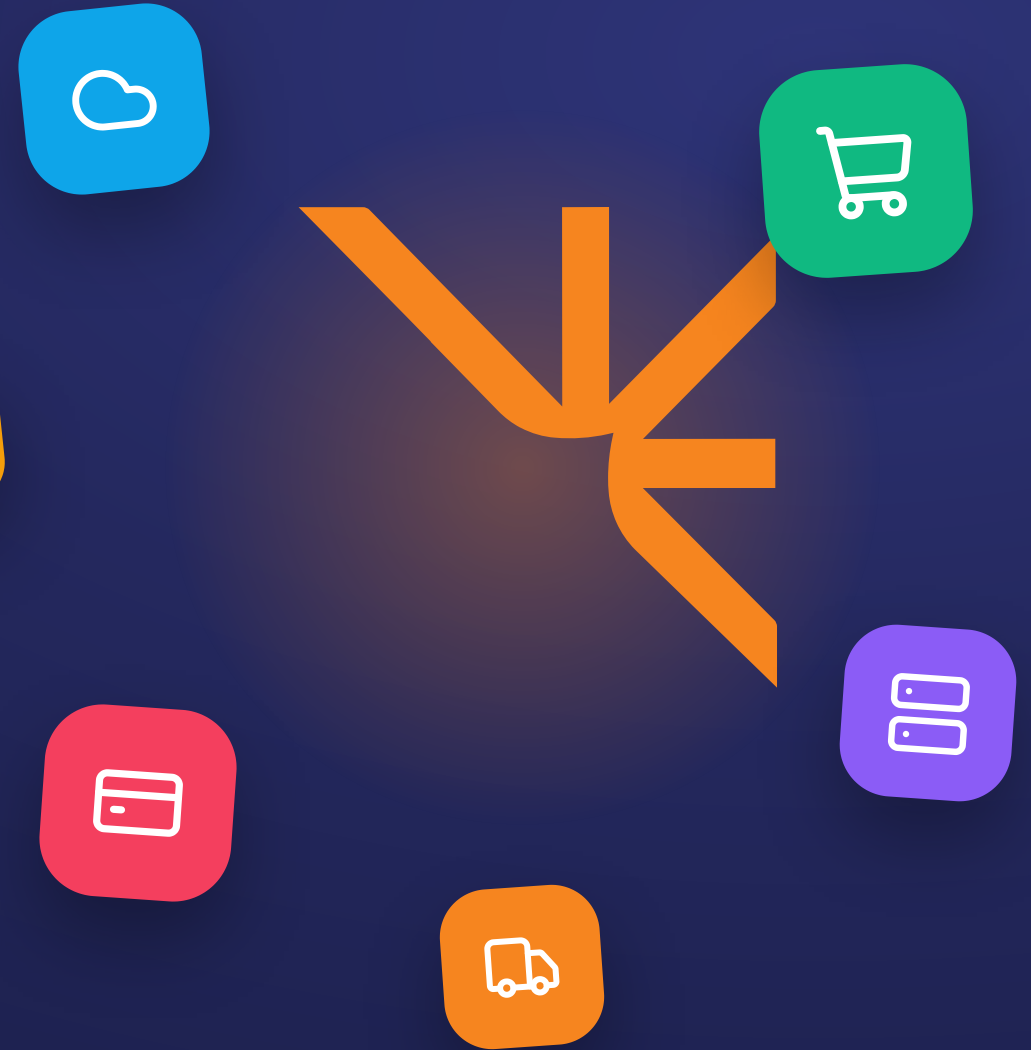
Everything you need to know — from cloud software to running an online store — explained for your work at NLC.

البرمجيات كخدمة والبيع عبر الإنترنت

📁 6 modules

🕒 ~ 90 min

👁️ Visual first



HOW TO USE THIS COURSE

Built for a busy, fast-moving brain



One module per sitting

10–15 min each. Stop at the checkpoint, take a break.



Read the headline first

Every slide title **is** the lesson. The rest is detail.



Checkpoints = mini-quizzes

Answers are printed upside-down at the bottom.



Print Module 6

Checklist, glossary and the one-page cheat sheet.

COLOR BOXES YOU WILL SEE



Remember: the one thing to keep from a slide



At NLC: how it applies to National Lighting Company



Saudi rule: a Saudi law, platform or market fact



Quick win: something you can do this week



Watch out: a common and costly mistake

COURSE MAP

Your learning path: 6 short modules



01

SaaS 101

What SaaS is and how it is priced

🕒 12 min



02

SaaS at NLC

Tools that make your job easier

🕒 15 min



03

Selling Online

Channels, customers, product pages

🕒 15 min



04

The Backend

Everything behind the “Buy” button

🕒 20 min



05

Salla vs DIY

Rent a platform or build your own?

🕒 18 min



06

Action Plan

90-day roadmap, checklists, glossary

🕒 10 min

🕒 ≈ 12 min

What is SaaS, really?

YOU WILL LEARN

- ✓ SaaS explained in one sentence
- ✓ The “pizza” model: IaaS · PaaS · SaaS
- ✓ How SaaS is priced (and the traps)



THE ONE-SENTENCE VERSION

SaaS = **renting** software over the internet

**Software**

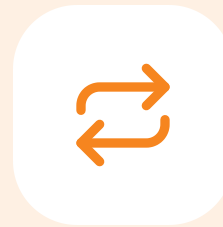
ready to use

+

**Internet**

open in a browser

+

**Subscription**

pay monthly / yearly

=



البرمجيات كخدمة

YOU ALREADY USE IT:

Gmail

Microsoft 365

Salla

Zoho

Canva

Zoom

Claude

**Remember:** Like **Netflix** instead of buying DVDs — you pay to **use** it, someone else keeps it running.

SPOT THE DIFFERENCE

Old way vs SaaS way



The old way

On-premise software



Big license fee upfront



Install on your own servers



Your IT team fixes & updates



Painful upgrade projects



Mostly works from the office



The SaaS way

Cloud subscription



Small monthly / yearly fee



Just log in — browser or app



Vendor runs servers & security



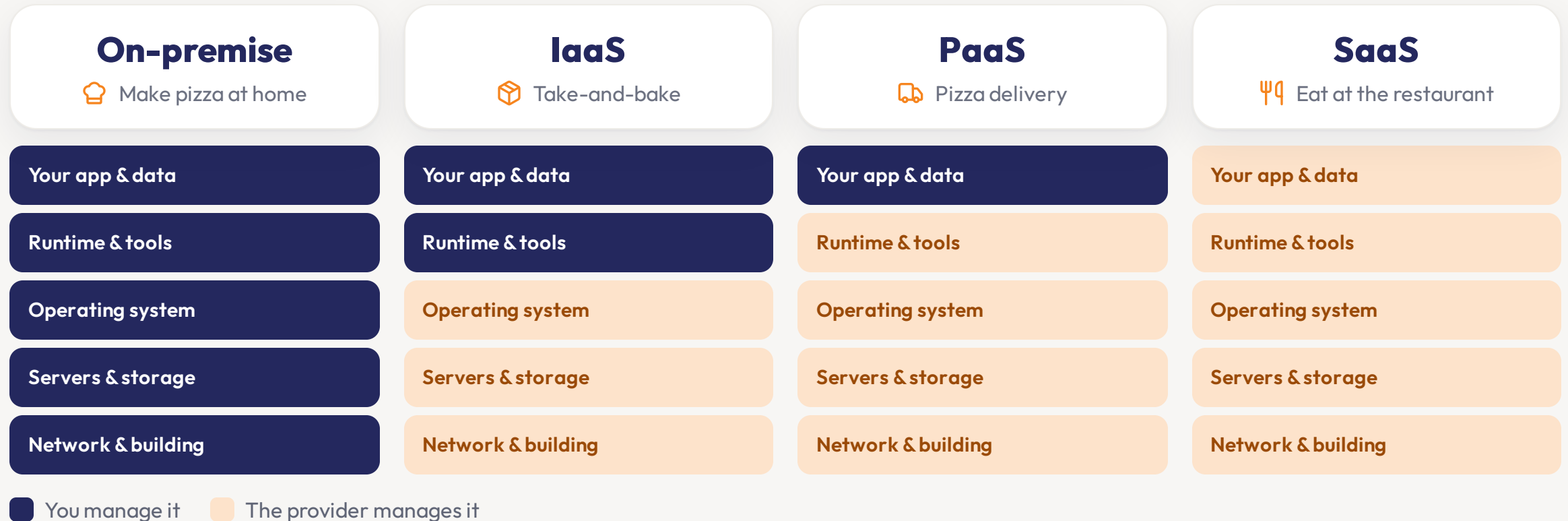
New features arrive automatically



Works anywhere, any device

CLOUD IN ONE PICTURE

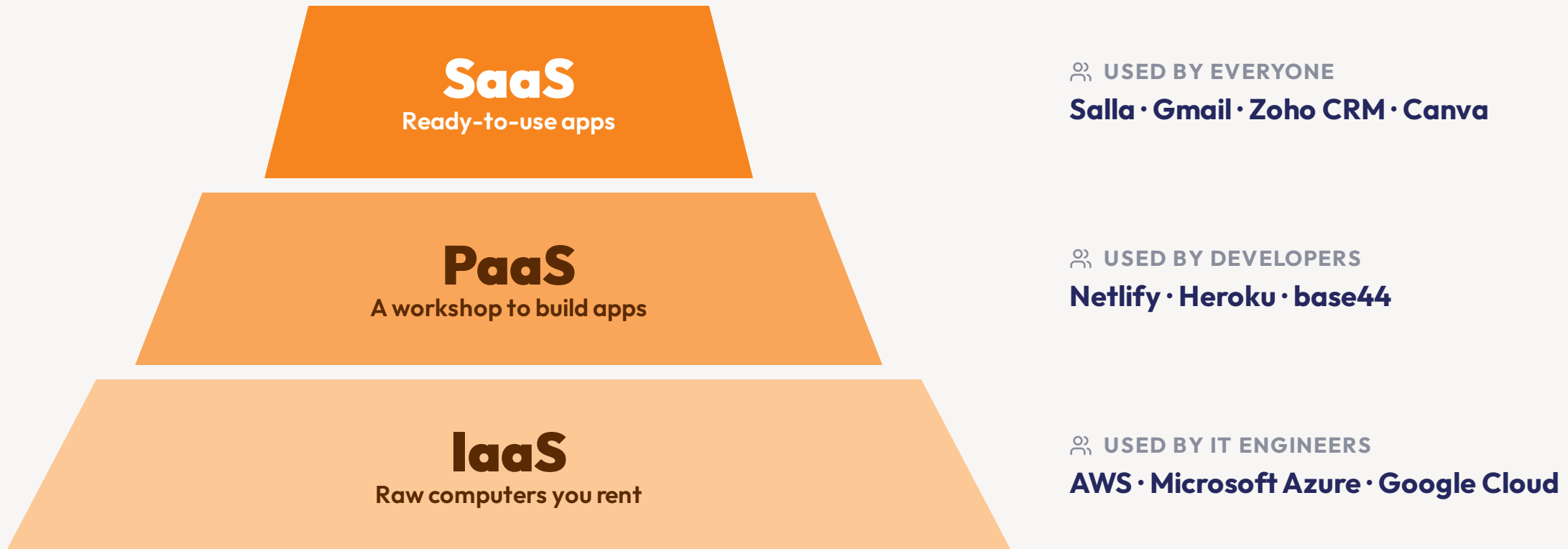
The pizza model: who does the work?



Remember: Salla is SaaS: NLC only brings products, prices and customers. Salla runs everything else.

IAAS · PAAS · SAAS

3 layers of cloud — you mostly live at the top



QUICK TEST

5 signs that something is SaaS



Subscription

Monthly or yearly fee, not a one-time purchase.



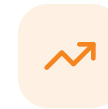
Log in anywhere

Browser or app. Nothing to install on servers.



Auto-updates

New features just appear. No upgrade projects.



Scales with you

Add users or a bigger plan in minutes.



Vendor runs it

Servers, backups and security are their job.



Quick win: Open any tool you use at work and run this test. Most will score 5 / 5.

PROS & CONS

The deal: **speed** in exchange for **control**

Why companies love it

- ✓ Low cost to start
- ✓ Live in days, not months
- ✓ No servers, no IT headaches
- ✓ Always the latest version
- ✓ Pay only for what you use

The trade-offs

- ✗ You pay forever — it never “ends”
- ✗ Limited customization
- ✗ Your data sits on their servers
- ✗ Hard to leave (vendor lock-in)
- ✗ If they go down, you go down

PRICING MODELS

5 ways SaaS charges you



Per user

Each person = 1 seat.
CRM, email, HR tools.



Tiered plans

Basic → Pro →
Enterprise. Salla, Zid,
Shopify.



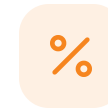
Usage-based

Pay per SMS, GB, API
call or order.



Freemium

Free core product, pay
for the good stuff.



% of each sale

Payment fees taken
from every order.



Watch out: Small fees add up: **10 tools × 5 users × SAR 100/month = SAR 60,000 a year.**

VOCABULARY

8 words you will hear in every SaaS meeting

**Churn**

Customers who cancel.
Vendors fear it.

**Seat / License**

One user account you pay for.

**Integration / API**

How one tool talks to another
automatically.

**SSO & MFA**

One login for all tools + a
second security code.

**SLA / Uptime**

99.9% uptime ≈ 8.8 hours
offline per year.

**Data export**

Can you take your data with
you if you leave?

**MRR / ARR**

Monthly / annual recurring
revenue — how SaaS firms
measure growth.

**Onboarding**

Setup + training period.
Budget time for it.

MODULE 1 REVIEW

Checkpoint ✓ 3 quick questions

1

Salla, Gmail and Zoho CRM are examples of...

A IaaS

B PaaS

C SaaS

2

The biggest trade-off of SaaS is...

A Slow to launch

B Less control & lock-in

C Needs your own servers

3

“% of each sale” pricing usually applies to...

A Payment processing

B Email tools

C Design software

Answers: 1 → C (SaaS) · 2 → B (less control & lock-in) · 3 → A (payment processing)

🕒 ≈ 15 min

How SaaS powers your work at NLC

YOU WILL LEARN

- ✓ The SaaS you already use (surprise!)
- ✓ A SaaS map for every NLC department
- ✓ How to pick tools without regret

02



LOOK AT YOUR OWN WEBSITE

Surprise: NLC already runs on SaaS



base44

Runs the **NLC Portal**: every datasheet registration (PortalUser, BlockedDomain).



Formsubmit.co

Emails every download-gate sign-up to info@nlc.com.sa.



GitHub

Stores the website code and every change ever made.



Google Fonts & CDNs

Deliver fonts and scripts to nlc.com.sa visitors.



Claude

The AI assistant that built this course. Also SaaS!



Email & office suite

Your inbox, calendar and files live in the cloud.



At NLC: Your datasheet download gate is already a mini SaaS pipeline: **website** → **Formsubmit** → **email** → **base44**.

THE NLC SAAS MAP

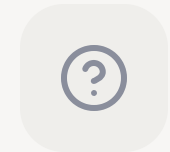
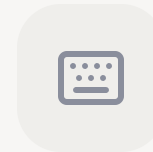
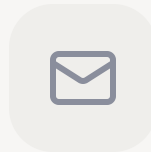
One SaaS toolbox for every department



SALES · CRM + AUTOMATION

Use case: turn datasheet downloads into **deals**

TODAY

**Datasheet download**

Visitor fills the gate form

Email to info@

Lands in a shared inbox

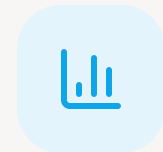
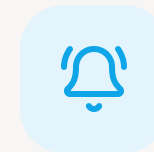
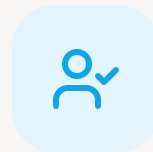
Copy by hand

Someone types it into base44

Follow-up?

Depends who saw it

WITH A CRM + AUTOMATION

**Datasheet download**

Same form, same website

Lead auto-created

Pushed to the CRM instantly

Auto-assigned

Right sales rep by region / product

Follow-up task

Reminder + email within 24 h

Tracked to a deal

Quote → order on a dashboard

SALES · CPQ (CONFIGURE – PRICE – QUOTE)

Use case: project quotes in minutes, not days



At NLC: Your **142 product pages** already hold clean specs + datasheets. That is ready-made data for quotes **and** for an online store.

BEYOND SALES

4 more wins waiting for NLC



Dealer portal

Distributors check stock, reorder and download invoices 24/7 — fewer calls to sales.



Marketing automation

New product launched → auto email to engineers & consultants who downloaded similar datasheets.



Live dashboards

Sales by region, product family and rep — updated every hour, not every month.



One system, 3 companies

NLC + MDI + BMC on shared tools: one customer list, one price book.

HOW TO CHOOSE

8 questions before you buy any SaaS

**Arabic & right-to-left?**

Staff and customers need it.

**ZATCA-ready?**

For anything that issues invoices.

**Where is data stored?**

Personal data rules (PDPL).

**Does it connect?**

API, webhooks or Zapier to your other tools.

**Real yearly cost?**

Price × users × 12 + add-ons + setup.

**Free trial with our data?**

Test with real NLC products.

**Local support?**

Saudi partner, Arabic support, working hours.

**Easy to leave?**

Full data export in Excel / CSV.

WATCH-OUTS

4 traps that make SaaS messy



Subscription creep

Tools nobody uses still bill every month.



Personal accounts

Staff sign up with Gmail. They leave → the data leaves.



Data islands

Tools that don't talk = copy-paste all day.



Weak security

No MFA, ex-staff still have access.



Quick win: Keep a simple **SaaS register**: tool · owner · cost · renewal date · who has access. Review it every quarter.

MODULE 2 REVIEW

Checkpoint ✓ 3 quick questions

1

A CRM mainly helps NLC with...**A** Payroll**B** Tracking leads → deals**C** Hosting the website

2

Why sign up for SaaS with a company email?**A** It is cheaper**B** NLC keeps the account & data**C** Faster login

3

Which question matters most for an invoicing tool in KSA?**A** Is it ZATCA-ready?**B** Has dark mode?**C** Has a mobile app?

Answers: 1 → B · 2 → B · 3 → A

 ≈ 15 min

Selling online: the big picture

YOU WILL LEARN

- ✓ Where Saudi customers buy
- ✓ B2C vs B2B for a lighting company
- ✓ What makes a product page sell



MARKET SNAPSHOT

Saudi Arabia is **ready to buy online**



99.6%

of people in KSA use the internet

CST Saudi Internet Report 2025



76.9%

of internet users shop online

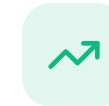
CST Saudi Internet Report 2025



79%

of retail payments were cashless in 2024

SAMA, 2025



SAR 88bn

spent online with mada cards in just 3 months (Q3 2025)

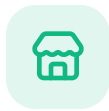
SAMA via SPA



Saudi rule: Vision 2030 target: **80% cashless by 2030**. Customers already expect mada & Apple Pay.

SALES CHANNELS

5 places you can sell online



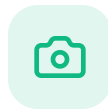
Your own store

Salla, Zid or custom.
Your brand, your data,
your rules.



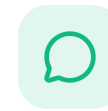
Marketplaces

Amazon.sa, Noon. Big
traffic, but high fees &
price wars.



Social commerce

Instagram, Snapchat,
TikTok. Where people
discover products.



WhatsApp

Catalog + chat +
payment link.
Contractors love it.



B2B & tenders

Etimad (government),
dealer portals, RFQs.



Remember: Your **own store is home base**. Every other channel should send people back to it.

KNOW YOUR BUYER

B2C and B2B are **two different games**

	 B2C · consumers	 B2B · businesses
Who buys	Homeowners, designers, small shops	Contractors, electricians, consultants, distributors
Order size	1 – 20 items	Hundreds to thousands
Price	One retail price incl. VAT	Price lists, volume discounts, negotiation
How they pay	mada, Apple Pay, cards, BNPL	Bank transfer, credit terms (30 / 60 days)
Decision	Minutes. Emotional.	Weeks. Specs, approvals, tenders.
Invoice	Simplified e-invoice with QR	Tax invoice with buyer's VAT number
Needs online	Photos, reviews, fast delivery	Datasheets, stock, quotes, fast reorder

PRODUCT FIT

What should NLC sell online?

SMALL ORDER → BIG ORDER

 B2B reorder portal

Same standard items, bought by the carton.

Distributors

Electricians

Price lists

Fast reorder

 Quote online, close with sales

Big, technical, project-based.

Street lights

High bay

Flood lights

Low-current

Power (MDI · BMC)



At NLC: Start with 20–30 “hero” items from the green box.

 Sell online now

Standard, fixed price, ships by courier.

Downlights

Strip lights

Track lights

Emergency

Solar

Wall lights

 “Request a quote” button

Custom versions of standard items.

Custom CCT

Special finish

Custom lengths

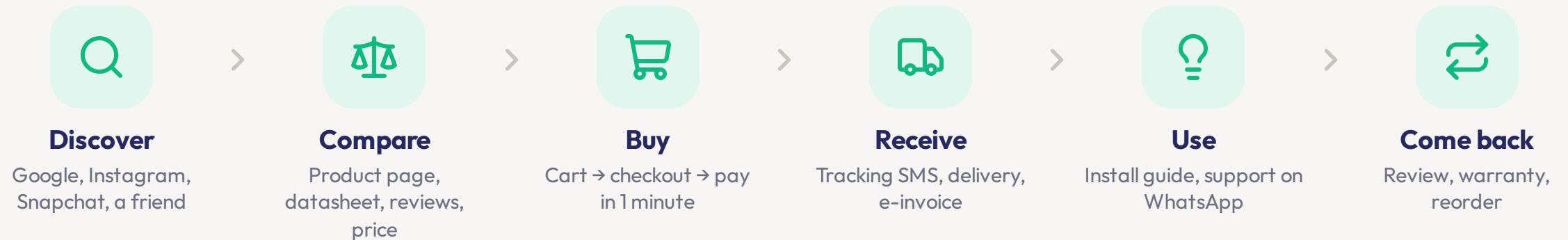


Quick win: Big projects still get a **“Request a quote”** form online, which feeds the CRM.

STANDARD PRODUCT → CUSTOM / PROJECT

FROM GOOGLE TO REORDER

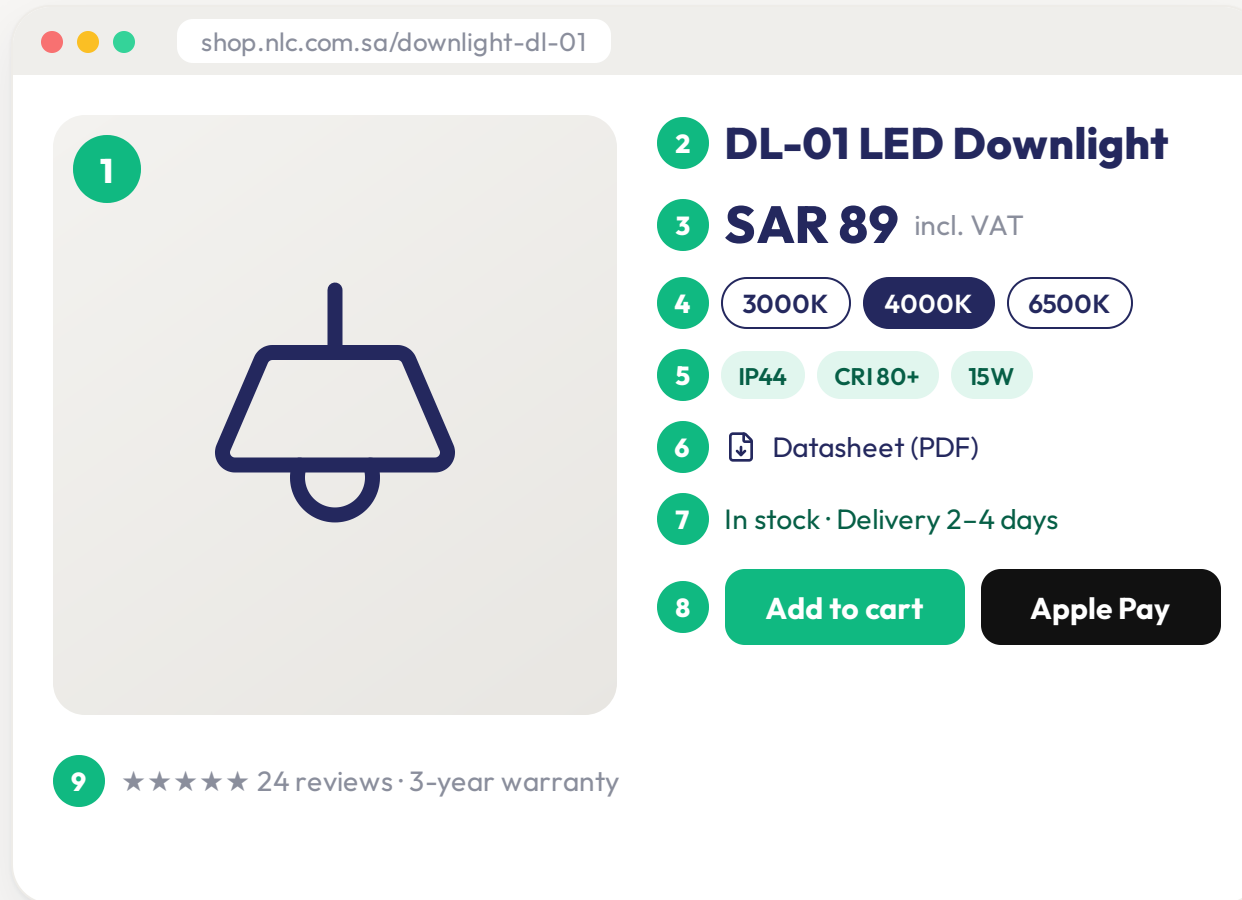
The customer journey: 6 steps, each one can fail



Remember: Most online sales are lost at **Compare** and **Buy**: unclear info, surprise fees, slow checkout.

9 ELEMENTS

Anatomy of a product page that sells



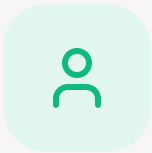
- | | |
|---------------------------|------------|
| 1 Product photos | NLC has it |
| 2 Name + model code | NLC has it |
| 3 Price incl. 15% VAT | To add |
| 4 Choose wattage / CCT | To add |
| 5 Key specs: IP, IK, CRI | NLC has it |
| 6 Datasheet download | NLC has it |
| 7 Stock + delivery time | To add |
| 8 Add to cart + Apple Pay | To add |
| 9 Reviews + warranty | To add |



At NLC: Your website already has **4 of 9**. The store adds the buying parts.

HOW ONLINE PAYMENT WORKS

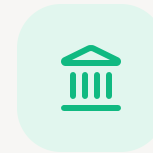
Follow the money: from card to NLC's bank

**Customer pays**

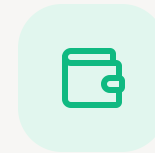
mada, Apple Pay, card

**Payment gateway**

Checks the card, fraud, 3-D Secure

**Banks & card network**

Approve and move the money

**NLC bank account**

Money arrives days later, minus the fee



EXAMPLE · SAR 500 ORDER PAID BY CREDIT CARD

SAR 500 — **SAR 13.50** (2.5% + SAR 1) = **SAR 486.50** to NLC

Typical Saudi gateway fees: mada ≈ 1–1.75%, credit cards ≈ 2.2–2.75% (often + SAR 1), plus VAT on the fee. Rates are negotiable — always get a written quote.

CHECKOUT OPTIONS

Payment methods Saudi buyers expect

**mada**

Saudi debit card network. A must-have.

**Apple Pay**

One tap on iPhone. Very popular.

**Visa · Mastercard**

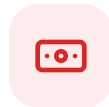
Credit cards, including foreign buyers.

**STC Pay**

Mobile wallet, popular with younger buyers.

**Tabby · Tamara**

Buy now, pay later. Higher fee ($\approx 2.5-7\%$).

**Cash on delivery**

Still common, but risky: refused parcels.

**Bank transfer**

For B2B and big orders, with credit terms.

**Purchase order**

Company approves first, pays on invoice.

KPIs

8 numbers that tell you if the store works

**Conversion rate** $\text{orders} \div \text{visitors}$ **Avg. order value** $\text{sales} \div \text{orders}$ **Cart abandonment** $\text{carts not paid} \div \text{all carts}$ **Cost per customer** $\text{marketing spend} \div \text{new customers}$ **ROAS** $\text{sales from ads} \div \text{ad spend}$ **Return rate** $\text{items returned} \div \text{items sold}$ **Repeat rate** $\text{returning buyers} \div \text{all buyers}$ **Rating** $\text{average review score}$ **Quick win:** Start with just **3**: conversion rate, average order value, cost per customer.

MODULE 3 REVIEW

Checkpoint ✓ 3 quick questions

1

Which NLC products fit online sales best at the start?

A Street light projects

B Standard downlights & strips

C Power distribution

2

A B2B buyer usually needs...

A Price lists & tax invoices

B Buy-now-pay-later

C Gift wrapping

3

Average order value (AOV) = ...

A Visitors ÷ orders

B Sales ÷ orders

C Ad spend ÷ sales

Answers: 1 → B · 2 → A · 3 → B

🕒 ≈ 20 min

The backend: behind the “Buy” button

YOU WILL LEARN

- ✓ The 12 building blocks of every online store
- ✓ Saudi must-haves: ZATCA, PDPL, SASO
- ✓ How all the systems connect



THE BIG IDEA

Frontend vs backend: a restaurant



Dining room

FRONTEND · what customers see



Menu = product pages



Table = shopping cart



Waiter = checkout



Decoration = design & brand



Kitchen

BACKEND · what makes it work



Pantry = inventory



Recipes = product data



Cashier = payments



Delivery driver = shipping



Accountant = invoices & VAT

THE BACKEND MAP

12 building blocks behind every online store



1

Product catalog



2

Inventory



3

Pricing & VAT



4

Checkout



5

Payments



6

Orders



7

Shipping



8

E-invoicing



9

Customers



10

Notifications



11

Security & hosting



12

Analytics



Remember: With **Salla**, most of these blocks come ready-made. **Building it yourself** means you own all 12.

Block 1 • Product data is the foundation



What it holds

- ✓ Name, model code, SKU
- ✓ Photos & gallery
- ✓ Specs: W, lm, CCT, IP, IK, CRI
- ✓ Datasheets & install guides
- ✓ Categories & search filters
- ✓ Arabic + English text

ONE PRODUCT → MANY SKUs



DL-01 Downlight

Wattage

10W

15W

20W

Color temp.

3000K

4000K

6500K

Finish

White

Black

$3 \times 3 \times 2 = 18$ **SKUs** to price & stock



At NLC: Your 142 product pages already have **specs, photos and datasheets**. Much of this block is already done.

Blocks 2–3 • Never sell what you don't have



Inventory

- ✓ Stock per warehouse (e.g. Dammam · Riyadh · Jeddah)
- ✓ Reserve stock the moment an order is paid
- ✓ Low-stock alerts
- ✓ Sync with the ERP so numbers match



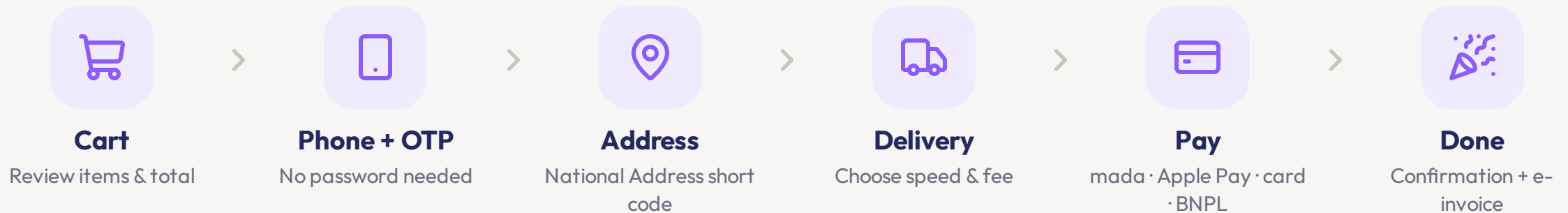
Pricing & VAT

- ✓ Show prices **including 15% VAT**
- ✓ B2B price lists & volume discounts
- ✓ Coupons, bundles, free-shipping rules
- ✓ One price source for website, store & sales team



Saudi rule: The E-Commerce Law requires the **total price incl. taxes & fees** to be shown clearly before purchase.

Blocks 4–5 • A checkout under 60 seconds

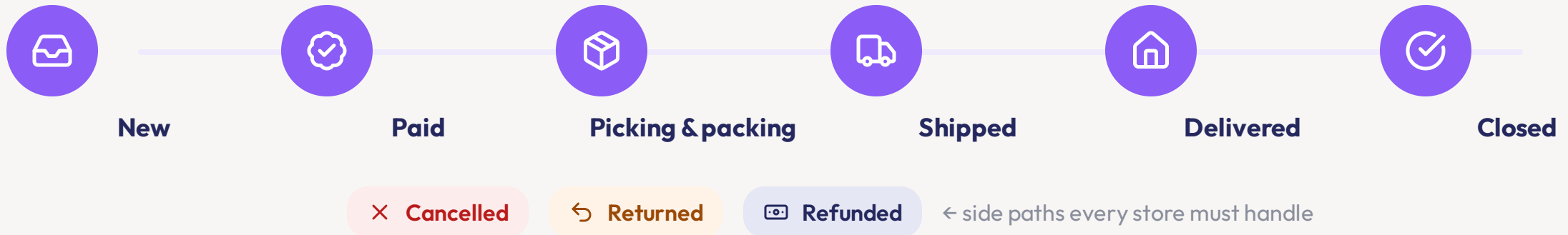


Quick win: Offer **Apple Pay & mada** on the first screen. Every extra step loses buyers.



Watch out: Never store card numbers yourself. Use the gateway's **hosted payment page** (keeps PCI DSS simple).

Block 6 • Every order walks the same path



 **Remember:** Each status change should **notify the customer** and **tell the right team** (warehouse, finance, support).

SHIPPING & DELIVERY

Block 7 • Getting the box to the door



Pack

Protective, branded box



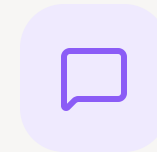
Label

From the platform or OTO /
Torod



Courier

SMSA • Aramex • SPL • J&T •
Naqel • Aymakan



Track

SMS / WhatsApp updates



Deliver

Home, office or RedBox locker



Saudi rule: Since Jan 2026, carriers must refuse parcels **without a National Address** short code.



Quick win: A typical parcel costs about **SAR 15–35**. Aggregators like OTO & Torod compare carriers.



At NLC: Lighting is **fragile**. Drop-test your packaging. Poles & bulk orders go by freight, not courier.

Block 8 • Every sale needs a ZATCA e-invoice

A PHASE 2 E-INVOICE HAS

-  Structured XML (UBL 2.1)
-  QR code
-  Cryptographic stamp
-  Unique invoice ID
-  VAT at 15%

B2C

Simplified invoice

Give it to the buyer, **report** to ZATCA within 24 hours.

**B2B**

Tax invoice

ZATCA must **clear** it in real time before the buyer gets it.



At NLC: NLC is almost certainly in Phase 2 already (check with Finance). The store must connect to a compliant system: **Salla Pro's ZATCA app** or your ERP.

Blocks 9–10 • Know your customer, keep them informed



Customer accounts

- ✓ Login with phone number + OTP
- ✓ Saved addresses & order history
- ✓ B2B company accounts: VAT number, several buyers
- ✓ Consent for marketing (PDPL)



Notifications

- ✓ Order confirmation + e-invoice
- ✓ Shipping & delivery updates
- ✓ Abandoned-cart reminders
- ✓ Sent by email, SMS or WhatsApp



Quick win: WhatsApp updates get read far more than emails. Most Saudi platforms support them.

Block 11 • Security & hosting: keep it up, keep it safe



HTTPS everywhere

Padlock in the browser. Free with most hosts.



Uptime & backups

Down = zero sales. Daily backups, tested.



Bot & attack protection

Firewall + DDoS protection (e.g. Cloudflare).



Admin MFA & roles

Every staff login gets 2-step verification.



Updates & patches

Old plugins are the #1 way stores get hacked.



PDPL compliance

Privacy policy, consent, report breaches within 72 h.



At NLC: Your admin page today uses a browser-side password. That is OK for a brochure site, **not** for customer data.

Block 12 • Measure everything, then grow



Google Analytics 4

Where visitors come from & where they drop off.



Ad pixels

Meta, Snapchat, TikTok, Google: pay for results.



SEO product pages

Rank for “LED downlight Riyadh”.



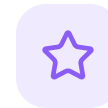
Email & WhatsApp

New products, offers, reorder reminders.



Abandoned cart

Auto-reminder. Wins back lost sales.

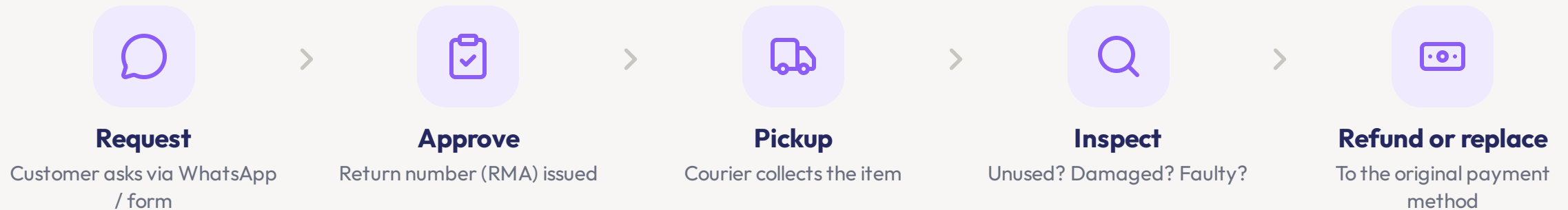


Reviews

Social proof for new buyers.

AFTER-SALE BACKEND

Bonus block · After the sale: returns, warranty, support



Saudi rule: Buyers can cancel within **7 days of delivery** if the item is unused. **Custom-made** goods can be excluded.



At NLC: Put your **warranty terms** on every product page. It builds trust with B2B buyers.

COMPLIANCE

Saudi legal checklist for an online store



Company

- ☐ CR includes the **e-commerce** activity
- ☐ Store registered on the **Business Platform** (business.sa, formerly Maroof)
- ☐ VAT registration + **ZATCA Phase 2**



Store must show

- ☐ Legal name, CR & VAT numbers, address, contact
- ☐ Total price incl. VAT & fees, delivery terms
- ☐ Return & cancellation policy + complaints channel



Customer data

- ☐ Privacy policy **before** collecting data (PDPL)
- ☐ Clear consent for marketing
- ☐ Breach notice to SDAIA within 72 h



Watch out: Breaking the E-Commerce Law can mean fines up to **SAR 1 million** and/or the store being suspended.

PRODUCT COMPLIANCE

Lighting-specific: SASO rules still apply online

**SABER certificate**

Product Certificate of Conformity per product, valid 1 year. Imports also need a shipment certificate.

**SASO 2870 · lamps**

Energy efficiency, functionality & the energy label for light sources.

**SASO 2902 · luminaires**

Efficiency rules for fittings. Updated version in the local market since June 2026.

**Safety (IECEE)**

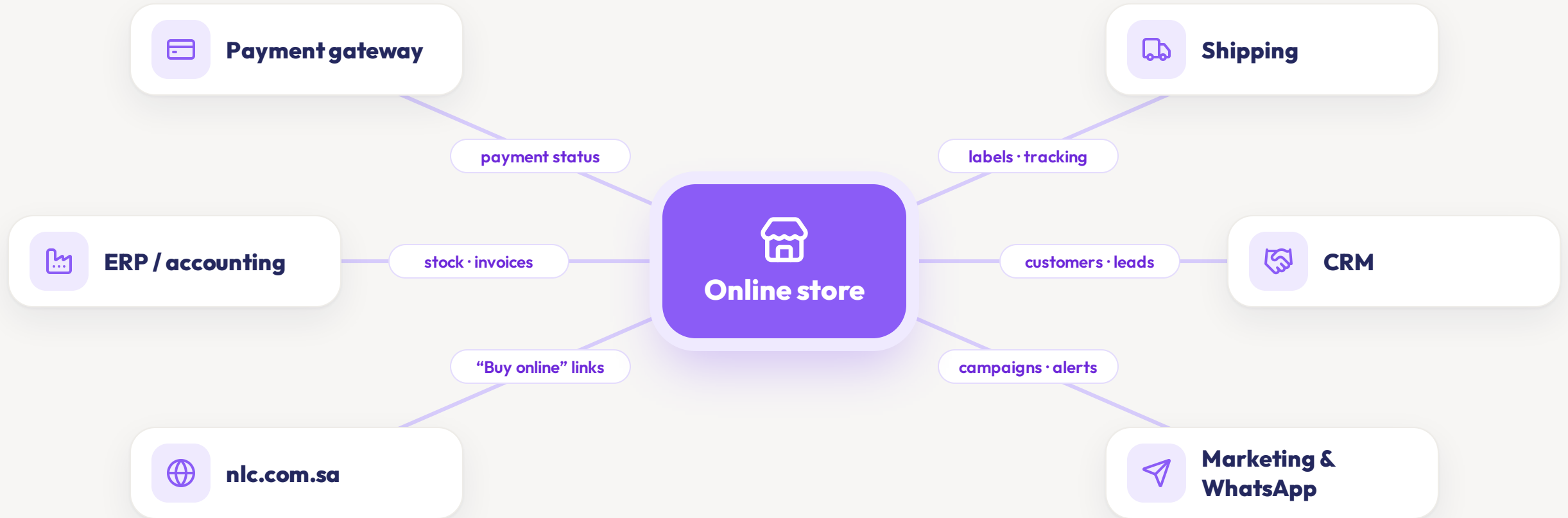
SASO IECEE certificate based on a CB test report.



Quick win: Show the **energy class & certificates** on product pages. Consultants and contractors look for them. Link your certifications page.

INTEGRATION MAP

How it all connects



MODULE 4 REVIEW

Checkpoint ✓ 3 quick questions

1

A B2B tax invoice in Phase 2 must be...

A Printed & stamped

B Cleared by ZATCA first

C Sent within 30 days

2

Since 2026, parcels without this are refused:

A National Address code

B Arabic label

C Insurance

3

The safest way to accept cards is...

A Store cards in your DB

B Gateway hosted page

C Ask by phone

Answers: 1 → B · 2 → A · 3 → B

 ≈ 18 min

Salla or build it yourself?

YOU WILL LEARN

- ✓ The 3 paths: rent, assemble or build
- ✓ Real costs over 3 years
- ✓ A clear recommendation for NLC



RENT · ASSEMBLE · BUILD

3 ways to get an online store



1

Rent (SaaS)

Like renting a **furnished shop in a mall**.
Move in next week.

Salla · Zid · Shopify

Speed to launch



Control



Your effort



2

Assemble (open source)

Like leasing an **empty unit** and fitting it out
yourself.

WooCommerce · Magento

Speed to launch



Control



Your effort



3

Build (custom code)

Like **constructing your own building**.
Anything goes, but slowly.

Laravel · Node · headless

Speed to launch



Control



Your effort





SAUDI SAAS E-COMMERCE PLATFORM

Salla in one slide



Built for KSA

Arabic-first, SAR, local support & partners.



Payments built in

mada, cards, Apple Pay, STC Pay, Tabby, Tamara.



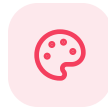
Shipping built in

One contract: Aramex, DHL, SMSA, Aymakan, RedBox, J&T.



ZATCA app

Phase 2 e-invoicing on **Pro** and **Special** plans.



Themes + App Store

Twilight themes; add features with apps.



API & webhooks

Developers can connect ERP, CRM or a custom front.

PRICING

Salla plans (Sept 2026)

Basic

Free

- ✓ Unlimited products
- ✓ Start selling, learn
- ✓ No ZATCA app

Plus

SAR 99

/ month · SAR 990 / yr

- ✓ 1 branch
- ✓ Weekly payouts
- ✓ No ZATCA app

☆ MINIMUM FOR NLC

Pro

SAR 299

/ month · SAR 2,990 / yr

- ✓ ZATCA Phase 2 app
- ✓ Up to 5 branches / warehouses
- ✓ Faster payouts (48 h)

Special

Custom

enterprise quote

- ✓ Everything in Pro
- ✓ Up to daily payouts
- ✓ Dedicated account team



At NLC: Why Pro? You need the **ZATCA app** and **several warehouses**.



Watch out: Plus payment fees on every order and paid apps. **Confirm current prices** on salla.sa.



SPLIT OF WORK

With Salla: **who does what?**



Salla handles

-  Hosting, speed & uptime
-  Security & card safety (PCI)
-  Checkout & payments
-  ZATCA e-invoices (Pro+)
-  Courier connections
-  Updates & new features



NLC handles

-  Products, photos, prices
-  Stock, packing & dispatch
-  Marketing & ads
-  Customer service & returns
-  Policies & SASO documents
-  B2B deals & big projects

THE DIY REALITY

Build it yourself = you own all 12 blocks

 Product catalog Inventory Pricing & VAT Checkout Payments Orders Shipping E-invoicing Customers Notifications Security & hosting Analytics

THE TEAM YOU NEED (IN-HOUSE OR AGENCY)



Product owner



UX / UI designer



Frontend dev



Backend dev



DevOps / hosting



QA tester



Security review

ZATCA
integration

Remember: Launch takes **months, not days**. After launch, the team never really goes away.

SALLA VS WOOCOMMERCE VS CUSTOM

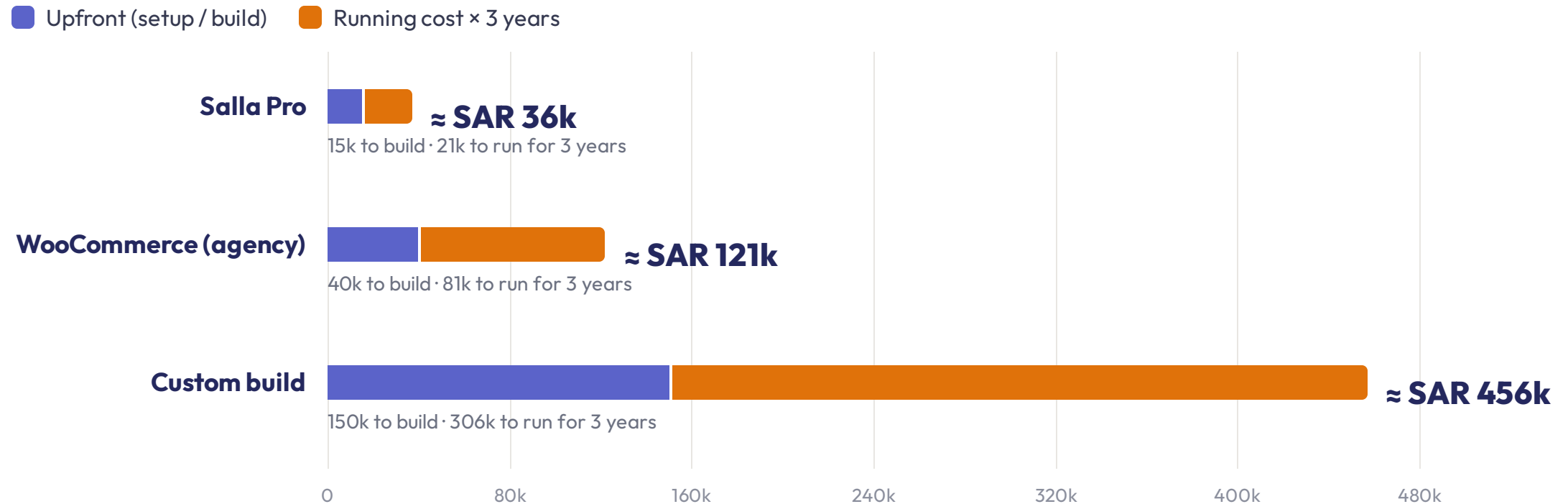
Head to head

	 Salla (SaaS)	 WooCommerce	 Custom build
Time to launch	Days – weeks	1 – 3 months	3 – 9+ months
Upfront cost			
Running cost			
Customization			
B2B features	Via apps	Via plugins	Anything you build
ZATCA Phase 2	Built-in app (Pro+)	Plugin or ERP	You integrate
Security & PCI	Salla's job	Your job	Your job
Data ownership	Export, some limits	Full	Full
Risk			

Dots = more (●●●●● = highest). For cost and risk, more dots is worse.

ILLUSTRATIVE ESTIMATE, SAR

3-year cost: more than 10× apart



Illustrative mid-range estimates from typical Saudi agency prices (low reliability, so get 3 quotes). Salla: Pro plan + apps + setup. WooCommerce: agency build, hosting & maintenance. Custom: B2B-ready build + small dev team. Excludes payment fees, shipping, marketing & staff, which are similar for all options.

READ THE SMALL PRINT

Hidden costs nobody puts in the proposal



Salla hidden costs

- ✓ Paid apps & premium theme
- ✓ Payment fee on **every** order
- ✓ Plan limits → pushed to a higher plan
- ✓ Lock-in: leaving means rebuilding the store



DIY hidden costs

- ✓ Hosting, security patches, backups
- ✓ Developer leaves → nobody knows the code
- ✓ ZATCA & gateway rules change → rework
- ✓ Every new feature = a new invoice



Quick win: Ask every vendor for a **3-year total cost** in writing, not just a monthly price.

HYBRID & HEADLESS

The middle path: keep your site, rent the engine

OPTION A · START HERE

Brand site + Salla shop

**nlc.com.sa**

Brand, catalog, datasheets (keep as is)

**“Buy online” button**

On each product page

**shop.nlc.com.sa**

Salla store in NLC colors

OPTION B · LATER

Headless commerce

**Custom NLC front**

Your design, your B2B screens

**API connection**

Products, cart, orders

**SaaS backend**

Salla / Shopify do the heavy lifting

SALLA VS ZID VS SHOPIFY

Salla isn't the only SaaS option

	Salla 	Zid 	Shopify 
Monthly plans	Free · SAR 99 · SAR 299 · custom	Free · SAR 99 · SAR 299 · custom	\$29 – \$299 (Plus from \$2,300)
Built-in payments	Salla Payments	Zid Pay	Not in KSA → Tap, Moyasar, HyperPay...
Arabic & local support	Excellent	Excellent	Via themes & partners
ZATCA Phase 2	App on Pro / Special	Check plan	Via third-party apps
Stand-out extra	Shipping labels, big app store	POS + WhatsApp	Global app ecosystem



Quick win: Ask Salla **and** Zid for a demo with 5 real NLC products. Compare fees in writing.

DECISION GUIDE

Which path fits? Find your row



Need to launch fast, with mostly standard products & fixed prices?



SaaS: Salla / Zid

Launch in weeks, learn cheaply

NLC TODAY



Complex B2B pricing, contractor accounts, quotes?



SaaS + B2B apps, or headless

Add B2B on top, custom front if needed



Own dev team + unique process + high volume?



Custom build

Full control, full responsibility

Answer yes to more than one? Start with the first matching row and move down as you grow.

RECOMMENDATION

The verdict for NLC: **rent first, build later**

NOW

Salla Pro store

20–30 hero products, linked from nlc.com.sa product pages.

1

6–12 MONTHS

Add B2B

Contractor accounts, price lists, “request a quote” into the CRM.

2

WHEN VOLUME PROVES IT

Go headless / custom

Deep ERP + B2B needs, custom NLC front on a SaaS or custom backend.

3



Remember: Salla lets NLC **learn what sells** for about SAR 3,000 a year in plan fees. Build only once the numbers justify it.

MODULE 5 REVIEW

Checkpoint ✓ 3 quick questions

1

Which Salla plan is the minimum for NLC?

A Basic

B Plus

C Pro

2

The biggest DIY risk is...

A Too few themes

B Owning security & maintenance forever

C No Arabic

3

“Headless” means...

A No website

B Custom front + platform backend

C No payments

Answers: 1 → C (Pro, for the ZATCA app) · 2 → B · 3 → B

 ≈ 10 min

Your 90-day action plan

YOU WILL LEARN

- ✓ A month-by-month launch roadmap
- ✓ Checklists & vendor questions
- ✓ Glossary + one-page cheat sheet



ROADMAP

90 days from zero to your first online orders



DAYS 1–30

Prepare

- ☐ Confirm CR e-commerce activity + business.sa
- ☐ Pick 20–30 hero products
- ☐ Set prices incl. VAT + shipping rules
- ☐ Collect SASO certificates
- ☐ Write return, warranty & privacy policies



DAYS 31–60

Build

- ☐ Open Salla Pro → shop.nlc.com.sa
- ☐ Apply NLC brand: navy, orange, logo
- ☐ Upload products, photos, datasheets
- ☐ Turn on payments, shipping, ZATCA app
- ☐ Add “Buy online” buttons on nlc.com.sa



DAYS 61–90

Launch & learn

- ☐ Soft launch: staff & friendly clients
- ☐ Fix what breaks, test every payment
- ☐ Launch campaign: Instagram, Snapchat, Google
- ☐ Weekly KPI review (next slides)
- ☐ Plan phase 2: B2B



TICK EVERY BOX

Pre-launch checklist (print me)



Legal

- ☐ CR + business.sa registration
- ☐ CR & VAT numbers in the footer
- ☐ Return / cancellation policy
- ☐ Privacy policy (PDPL)
- ☐ Terms in Arabic & English



Store

- ☐ Prices shown incl. VAT
- ☐ Photos + datasheets on every item
- ☐ Test order: mada, Apple Pay, card
- ☐ Checkout tested on a phone
- ☐ Test ZATCA invoice issued



Operations

- ☐ Packaging drop-tested
- ☐ Courier pickup booked
- ☐ Return process agreed
- ☐ WhatsApp support number
- ☐ Who answers orders on weekends?



SALLA, ZID OR ANY AGENCY

8 questions to ask before you sign anything

- 1 Which plan includes **ZATCA Phase 2**?
- 2 What are **all** fees per order (platform + payment)?
- 3 When do we get paid (payout schedule)?
- 4 Can we do **B2B price lists** & capture VAT numbers?
- 5 Can we export products, customers & orders anytime?
- 6 Which paid apps will we need, and at what cost?
- 7 Where is customer data stored (PDPL)?
- 8 What support do we get: hours, language, response time?

FILL EVERY WEEK

Your Monday dashboard (10 minutes)

**Visitors**

This week

vs last week ↑↓

**Conversion %**

This week

vs last week ↑↓

**Orders**

This week

vs last week ↑↓

**Avg. order (SAR)**

This week

vs last week ↑↓

**Abandoned carts %**

This week

vs last week ↑↓

**ROAS**

This week

vs last week ↑↓

**Returns**

This week

vs last week ↑↓

**Top 5 products**

This week

vs last week ↑↓

**Quick win:** Ask one question every Monday: **what is the one thing we change this week?**



QUICK REFERENCE

Glossary 1/2

API

A doorway that lets two systems exchange data automatically.

AOV

Average order value: $\text{sales} \div \text{orders}$.

B2B / B2C

Selling to businesses / to consumers.

BNPL

Buy now, pay later: Tabby, Tamara.

CDN

Servers worldwide that make a site load fast.

COD

Cash on delivery.

CR

Commercial Registration
السجل التجاري

CRM

System that tracks customers, leads & deals.

ERP

Company backbone: stock, finance, purchasing, production.

Headless

Custom front end on top of a platform's backend.

IaaS / PaaS

Renting raw servers / a platform to build apps.

KPI

Key performance indicator: a number you track.

QUICK REFERENCE

Glossary 2/2

mada

Saudi national debit card network.

MFA

A 2nd login step: a code or an app.

OMS

Order management system.

PCI DSS

Security rules for handling card data.

PDPL

Saudi Personal Data Protection Law (SDAIA).

PIM

Product information management: the catalog brain.

SaaS

Software rented over the internet.

SABER

SASO platform for product conformity certificates.

SASO

Saudi Standards, Metrology & Quality Org.

SKU

One sellable version: e.g. DL-01 · 15W · 4000K.

SLA

Promised service level, e.g. 99.9% uptime.

ZATCA · Fatoora

Tax authority & its e-invoicing system.

CHEAT SHEET

The whole course on one page

SAAS 101

SaaS = renting software. Fast & cheap to start; you trade away control & pay forever.

SAAS AT NLC

NLC already uses SaaS. Next wins: CRM for leads, ZATCA-ready finance, dashboards.

SELLING ONLINE

Sell standard items online (B2C). Big projects: quote online, close with sales (B2B).

THE BACKEND

12 backend blocks + Saudi must-haves: ZATCA Phase 2, PDPL, National Address, SASO.

SALLA VS DIY

Salla Pro first ($\approx$ SAR 3k/yr in plan fees). Custom only when volume proves it.

ACTION PLAN

90 days: prepare $\rightarrow$ build $\rightarrow$ launch. Track 3 KPIs every Monday.

CHECKED 29 SEPT 2026

Sources & fact-check

Fact	Where it comes from
Salla plans, ZATCA app, payouts, shipping	salla.sa/site/pricing · help.salla.sa · salla.com/en/payments
Zid plans & Zid Pay	zid.sa/ar/pricing
Shopify prices & Saudi gateways	shopify.com/pricing · shopify.com/payment-gateways/saudi-arabia
E-Commerce Law (Royal Decree M/126, 2019)	Tamimi & Co. · Mondaq summaries of the law & regulations
Business Platform replaced Maroof (Mar 2023)	mc.gov.sa news, 29-03-2023
PDPL obligations & dates	Morgan Lewis (Sep 2024) · DataGuidance
ZATCA e-invoicing Phase 2 & waves	zatca.gov.sa: E-Invoicing Detailed Guideline, Wave 24/25 news
SASO lighting (2870 / 2902 / 2927, IECEE)	UL Solutions news · saso.gov.sa · Saudipedia (SABER)
National Address rule for parcels (2026)	Saudi Press Agency (spa.gov.sa)
Internet & online shopping stats	CST Saudi Internet Report 2025
Cashless share, mada online spend	SAMA · Saudi Press Agency
Gateway / BNPL fees, build-cost ranges	Third-party guides (typical ranges, verify with vendors)

Prices and fees change often. Confirm them with the vendor before any decision.



You did it!

Now you speak SaaS and e-commerce. Your next 3 moves:

- 1  Share this deck with your manager
- 2  Book a Salla (and Zid) demo
- 3  Pick your 20 hero products this week

